USHODAYA HIGH SCHOOL

CLASS X – SOCIAL STUDIES

FA–2 PROJECT WORK

THE WORLD BETWEEN THE WORLD WARS (1914–1945)

Illustration: The World Wars, their impact, and the hope for international peace.

Name: _____ Class/Section: _____

Roll No.: _____ Date: _____

1. Introduction

The period from 1914 to 1945 was a major turning point in world history. It witnessed the First World War (1914–1918), the Great Depression, the rise of fascism and Nazism, and the Second World War (1939–1945). These events caused great human suffering and changed the political map of the world.

2. Objectives of the Project

• To understand the major causes and consequences of the two World Wars.
• To identify important events between 1914 and 1945.
• To learn why international cooperation and peaceful settlement of disputes are important.

3. The First World War (1914–1918)

The First World War began in Europe in 1914. Long-term causes included aggressive nationalism, imperial rivalry, militarism and rival alliances. The assassination of Archduke Franz Ferdinand of Austria-Hungary and his wife Sophie at Sarajevo in June 1914 was the immediate trigger. The conflict spread as countries joined opposing sides and ended in 1918.

4. The Treaty of Versailles and the League of Nations

The Treaty of Versailles was signed with Germany on 28 June 1919. It imposed territorial, military and financial conditions on Germany. The League of Nations was established in 1920 to encourage cooperation and prevent wars, but it could not stop the aggression that led to another world war.

5. The Great Depression and the Rise of Dictatorships

The Great Depression began in 1929 and caused widespread unemployment and economic hardship. In some countries, people lost faith in existing governments. Fascist and Nazi leaders gained support by promising national strength and quick solutions, while promoting authoritarian rule and aggressive expansion.

6. The Second World War (1939–1945)

The Second World War began in Europe on 1 September 1939, when Germany invaded Poland. Britain and France declared war on Germany two days later. The war spread across Europe, Africa and Asia. Germany invaded the Soviet Union in June 1941, and the conflict ended in 1945 after the defeat of the Axis powers.

7. Consequences of the World Wars

Both wars caused enormous loss of life, displacement and destruction of homes, farms, industries and transport systems. After the Second World War, the United States and the Soviet Union emerged as major superpowers. Anti-colonial movements grew stronger in Asia and Africa. The atomic bombings of Hiroshima and Nagasaki in August 1945 showed the devastating power of nuclear weapons.

8. International Cooperation for Peace

The United Nations Organisation (UNO) was founded in 1945 to promote international peace, security and cooperation. The International Labour Organization (ILO), established in 1919, works for labour rights and social justice. The World Health Organization (WHO) became a specialised agency of the United Nations in 1948. These institutions show the importance of countries working together on shared problems.

9. Learning Outcomes

Through this project, I learned that rivalry, aggressive nationalism, militarism and failure to resolve disputes peacefully can lead to devastating wars. Peace requires dialogue, diplomacy, respect for other countries and cooperation among nations. International organisations can help countries address common problems.

10. Conclusion

The years 1914–1945 changed the world politically, economically and socially. The suffering caused by the two World Wars reminds us that disagreements should be settled through discussion and negotiation. Protecting human life and maintaining peace must be shared responsibilities.

Pictures and Illustrations

Paste the provided illustration on Page 1. If your teacher asks for additional pictures, you may add a small picture of the Treaty of Versailles or the United Nations headquarters beside the related section.

Bibliography

Telangana State Class X Social Studies Textbook, Chapter 12: “World Between the World Wars (1914–1945)”.

Acknowledgement

I thank my Social Studies teacher for guidance and support in completing this project.